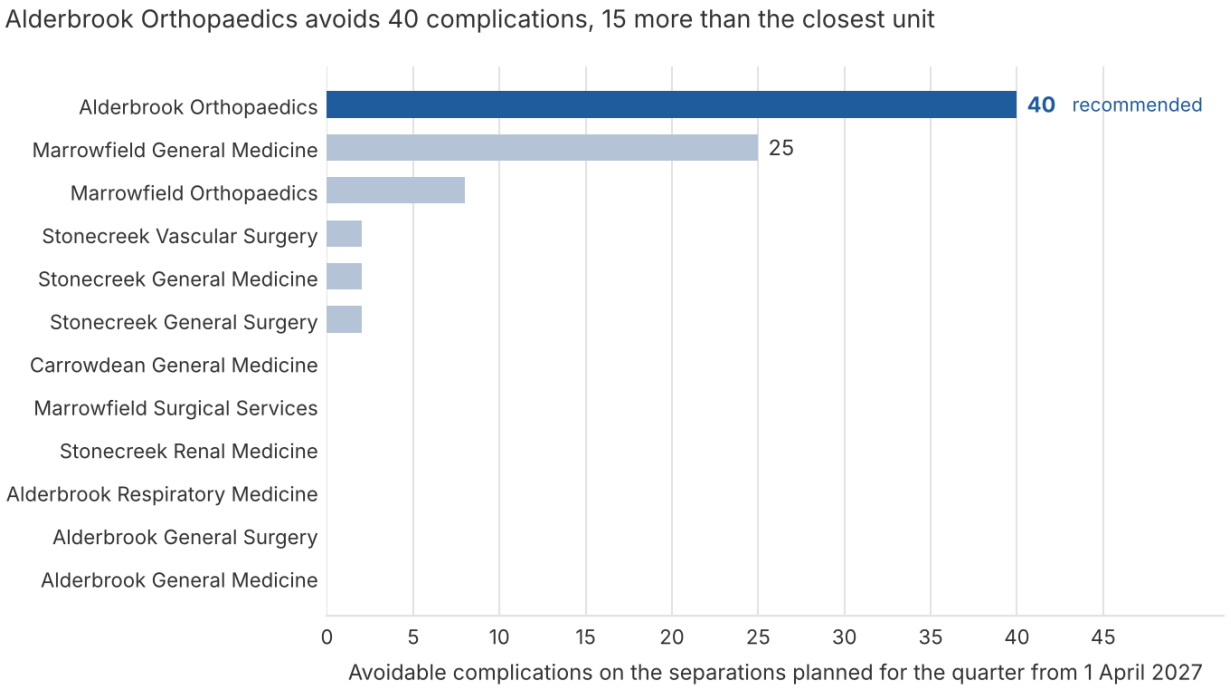
Place the IP-11 team with Alderbrook Orthopaedics: 40 avoidable complications, 15 more than the closest unit

Clinical Improvement Partnership, cycle IP-11 (1 April to 30 June 2027). For the Clinical Quality Committee, 24 March 2027. Prepared by Clinical Improvement.

The team should embed with **Orthopaedics at Alderbrook Hospital, cost centre 41230**. Its own patients had 1795 complications over the ten closed quarters of specification 4.0. Patients in the same risk bands and age bands, across the network's own record over the same quarters, had 1466.3. On the 2,305 separations the unit plans for the quarter that difference is **40 avoidable complications**, against 25 at Marrowfield General Medicine, the closest unit. The gap is 15 complications, 1.60 times, and 2.4 standard errors of its own sampling error, so it is not a difference the record could have produced by chance.



Every eligible unit, its planned activity for the quarter and the avoidable complications it is carrying, is in the placement workbook.

Why this is not the unit the quarterly indicator points at

Alderbrook General Surgery, cost centre 41220, records 59.2 complications above the published expectation on the quarter's planned activity, more than twice any other unit, and it is where the indicator report points. Measured against the complications its own patients would ordinarily have, it is carrying -3. The difference is its case mix. The stratum rates published with specification 4.0 were derived from activity in the year ended 30 June 2024 and clause 3.1 does not re-estimate them; the network's own rates now run from 0.89 to 1.31 of them, band by band, and the twelve units' surgical share of in-scope episodes runs from 7 per cent to 85 per cent. A unit whose patients sit where the published table has gone furthest out of date carries that gap as if it were its own practice.

The clearest case is **Marrowfield Orthopaedics**, cost centre 41410, which treated the same number of patients in every one of the ten quarters and changed nothing it does. For two of them its orthopaedic theatre was closed and its beds carried the hospital's emergency general surgical admissions instead. On the published expectation its complications above expectation jump from between 1.1 and 2.1 a quarter to 9.4 and 9.2. Measured against what its own patients would ordinarily have, the figure holds between 6.2 and 7.1 in every quarter, including those two.

Marrowfield General Medicine, cost centre 41420, is the unit with the worst avoidable rate, 23.0 avoidable complications per 1,000 separations against 17.4 here. It is the smaller unit: on the separations each plans for the

quarter it is carrying 25 avoidable complications against 40, so the team avoids more here. The placement is a quarter of one team's time, and what it buys is complications, not a rate.

How the figures were put together

Observed complications and the published expectation are specification 4.0's, from the episode extract to 31 December 2026, and tie to the quarterly indicator series on all 215 unit-quarters. The complications patients of a risk band and age band ordinarily have are the network's own: complications per in-scope episode in each of the 24 strata, over every closed quarter of the specification period, from the same extract. Each unit's avoidable complications are its own patients' complications less that expectation, taken patient by patient and summed, then carried onto the separations the activity plan plans for the quarter at the unit's own rate per separation, which is clause 3.4's basis. The twelve eligible units are charter clause 4.2's.

The ranking does not depend on how the comparison is drawn. Taking the network's own rates over the last eight quarters, the last four, or the latest quarter alone; leaving the unit's own patients out of the comparison; taking the unit's record over any of those windows; and carrying the rate on in-scope episodes rather than on all separations all put this unit first, by between 1.07 and 2.85 times.

Unit	Cost centre	Planned separations	Expected complications	Avoidable complications
Alderbrook Orthopaedics	41230	2,305	198.4	40
Marrowfield General Medicine	41420	1,089	86.0	25
Marrowfield Orthopaedics	41410	734	57.0	8
Stonecreek Vascular Surgery	41330	475	48.0	2
Stonecreek General Medicine	41310	1,365	109.7	2

Cost centre 41510 has reported under its own code since the Carrowdean medical wards were amalgamated on 1 October 2025, and its five closed quarters meet clause 4.2. Rehabilitation and Aged Care at Marrowfield, where the team is until 31 March, is not eligible this cycle. Avoidable complications are whole complications on the quarter's planned separations; expected complications and complications above the published expectation are carried to one decimal.